

FDTD: diffraction over objects

Alichan Borokov, Sam Hemati, Joran Van Haelst

December 2025

1 Introduction

2 Infinitely Thin Structure

2.1 Analytical diffraction around wedge

2.2 Results

3 Thick Object with Finite Impedance

3.1 Results

4 Tilted Boundaries

4.1 Finite Impedance

4.2 Refinement

In order to better model the non-cartesian surface, we included a grid refinement around the tilted boundaries.

This was achieved by making dx and dy functions of respectively x and y . As a first attempt both were made a step-function, in which around the boundaries they are both half of what they are elsewhere. This however results in reflections at the discontinuity in dx or dy , as can be seen in ???. Next, to remove these reflections, a buffer zone was added in both x - and y -direction in which dx and dy are linearly interpolated (see fig ???).

Both these were in practice implemented by taking the original discretisation coordinates, and transforming these, either partwise linearly (for the step-function in dx or dy), or with a parabolic part in the bufferzone (for the linear dx and dy).

There were dx or dy is not constant however, this results in an error in the update scheme. As, for example, the discretised o_x may no longer be halfway between two p 's. This means that in the update equations of o_x , it is erroneous to use $\frac{dp}{dx}$ as calculated by differentiating two neighbouring p 's. So an interpolation was made between three values of $\frac{dp}{dx}$ at the halfway point between two p 's: two

closest neighbours to the left, the two direct neighbours, and those to the right. Since there are three values, a parabolic interpolation was optimal. At the edges, where there are only two values to interpolate between, a linear interpolation was used instead. To update o_x , the interpolated $\frac{dp}{dx}$ at the location of o_x (after the coordinate transformation) was used.

Some results from the refinement and comparison with without: INSERT HERE.

4.3 Non Cartesian Grid

Another route that was explored is to tilt the grid. In this way the surface of the tilted boundary becomes flat on one side, thus removing the problems that arise from a staircase-like boundary. The left-side was chosen to be flat, as the most important reflections occur there.

Instead of working with x - and y -coordinates, a switch is made to u - and v -coordinates. These are related via equations 1 and 2, in which θ is the angle between the v -axis and the x -axis.

$$x = u + v \cos \theta \quad (1)$$

$$y = v \sin \theta \quad (2)$$

In figure ?? the basis-vectors are given. Note that $\vec{e}_x = \vec{e}_u$, but $x \neq u$. In this figure another vector, $\vec{e}_w$, is introduced. This vector is perpendicular to $\vec{e}_v$. With this figure the relations given in equations 3 and 4 are easily derived.

$$\vec{e}_w = \sin \theta \vec{e}_x - \cos \theta \vec{e}_y \quad (3)$$

$$\vec{e}_v = \cos \theta \vec{e}_x + \sin \theta \vec{e}_y \quad (4)$$

There is still an important choice remaining, namely, which directions of $\vec{\sigma}$ to store. A first idea might be to choose $o_u = \vec{e}_u \cdot \vec{\sigma}$ and $o_v = \vec{e}_v \cdot \vec{\sigma}$, as analogous to the cartesian grid. Remember however that the goal is to implement a tilted PEC-boundary, which has as boundary condition that $o_n = 0$, with n the normal of the boundary. For this boundary condition to be implemented simply, o_w and o_v are chosen, in which $\vec{e}_w$ is the normal of the tilted boundary (on the left side). An added benefit is that now both stored directions of $\vec{\sigma}$ are orthogonal to eachother, so no data overlaps. Figure ?? shows the location of a few p , o_w and o_v 's.

Now the update scheme can be adjusted for the tilted grid. To update p , the divergence of $\vec{\sigma}$ is needed at the location of p , with $\nabla \cdot \vec{\sigma} = \frac{do_w}{dw} + \frac{do_v}{dv}$. The following quantities are known:

$$\frac{do_v}{dv} \Big|_{v_0 + \Delta v / 2} \cdot \Delta v \approx o_v \Big|_{v_0 + \Delta v} - o_v \Big|_{v_0},$$

$$\frac{do_w}{du} \Big|_{u_0 + \Delta u / 2} \cdot \Delta u \approx o_w \Big|_{u_0 + \Delta u} - o_w \Big|_{u_0}.$$

$\frac{do_w}{dw}$ requires some more attention. From equations 4 and 3, the following can be derived:

$$\vec{e}_w = \frac{1}{\sin \theta} (\vec{e}_u - \cos \theta \vec{e}_v).$$

From which

$$\frac{do_w}{dw} = \vec{e}_w \cdot \nabla o_w = \frac{1}{\sin \theta} \left(\frac{do_w}{du} - \cos \theta \frac{do_w}{dv} \right)$$

follows. So the missing piece is $\frac{do_w}{dv}$, which can only be interpolated at p 's location by using

$$\frac{do_w}{dv} \Big|_{v_0} \cdot 2\Delta v \approx o_w \Big|_{v_0+\Delta v} - o_w \Big|_{v_0-\Delta v},$$

combined with

$$o_w \Big|_{u_0+\Delta u/2} \approx \frac{o_w \Big|_{u_0} + o_w \Big|_{u_0+\Delta u}}{2}.$$

For the update equations of $\vec{o}$ an analogous approach is followed.

$$\frac{dp_{\perp}}{dt} + c^2 \frac{do_{\alpha}}{d\alpha} + \kappa_{\perp} p_{\perp} = 0 \quad (5)$$

$$\frac{dp_{\parallel}}{dt} + c^2 \frac{do_{\gamma}}{d\gamma} + \kappa_{\parallel} p_{\parallel} = 0 \quad (6)$$

The perfectly matched layers in the tilted grid become a bit more complex. This especially for the upper PML. The update equations for $p = p_{\perp} + p_{\parallel}$ are given by equations 5 and 6. Looking at the upper PML, so that the perpendicular direction is $\vec{e}_y$ and the parallel one is $\vec{e}_x$, these equations become:

$$\frac{dp_{\perp}}{dt} + c^2 \frac{do_y}{dy} + \kappa_{\perp} p_{\perp} = 0,$$

$$\frac{dp_{\parallel}}{dt} + c^2 \frac{do_x}{dx} + \kappa_{\parallel} p_{\parallel} = 0.$$

By defining $\vec{p} = p_{\perp} \vec{e}_y + p_{\parallel} \vec{e}_x$ and $\vec{\kappa} = \kappa_{\perp} \vec{e}_y + \kappa_{\parallel} \vec{e}_x$, these can be rewritten in one equation as follows

$$\frac{d}{dt} \vec{e}_i \cdot \vec{p} + c^2 \vec{e}_i \cdot \nabla \vec{o} \cdot \vec{e}_i + |\vec{e}_i \cdot \vec{\kappa}| \vec{p} \cdot \vec{e}_i = 0$$

The absolute value of $\vec{e}_i \cdot \vec{\kappa}$ is important: if we chose $-\vec{e}_y$ instead of $\vec{e}_y$ as the perpendicular direction, ...

CN

BOUNDARY

5 Conclusion